

PELICAN BAY POLICE DEPARTMENT
HOMICIDE DIVISION — EIGHTH DISTRICT

715 South Broad Avenue, New Orleans, LA 70119
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WITNESS CANVASS REPORT — BOURBON STREET AREA

Case No.: PBPD-2025-088142 | Document No.: 10

Canvass Conducted By: Det. Renee Broussard #1887 / Officer Maria Thibodaux #2241
Canvass Date: October 4, 2025 — 9:00 AM – 2:30 PM
Area Canvassed: 700 block Bourbon Street, adjacent alleys, Conti Street block
Total Contacts Made: 22 individuals; 8 provided statements of varying value
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I. CANVASS METHODOLOGY

Officers conducted door-to-door canvass of all commercial establishments on the 700 block of Bourbon Street and adjacent properties. Businesses contacted: The Rusty Anchor (712), Magnolia Spirits Bar (714), Voodoo Lounge (708), Creole Kitchen (706), Bayou Gifts (710), and four residential/mixed-use buildings on Conti and Bienville Streets. Additionally, officers spoke with street vendors and night workers in the area.

II. SIGNIFICANT CONTACT — DARNELL WASHINGTON

DARNELL WASHINGTON, M/B, 41, residing at 718 Bourbon Street, Apt. 4 (above Magnolia Spirits). Mr. Washington was identified at the scene by Officer Thibodaux and formally interviewed during the canvass. Mr. Washington is a regular night-shift worker (riverboat tour operator, days off that night) who states he comes to the alley doorway most nights to smoke.

KEY STATEMENT: Washington states that at approximately 1:20 AM he observed three males exit through the staff door of The Rusty Anchor into the alley. He described them as 'white guys — three of them.' He states one was wearing a red shirt and one appeared to be in a dark jacket or hoodie. He could not provide facial descriptions — the alley is poorly lit and he was approximately 30 feet away. He states the men appeared 'amped up' and were moving quickly. He did not hear conversation clearly but noted raised voices.

Washington states he went back inside his building approximately five minutes later and heard 'some kind of commotion in the alley' — described as 'like something hitting the ground.' He did not look out. He heard nothing after that. He did not call 911.

NOTE: Travis Bell was confirmed by indoor bar surveillance to be wearing a RED SHORT-SLEEVE SHIRT on the night of October 3–4, 2025. Washington's description of a man in a red shirt is consistent with Travis Bell.

III. OTHER CONTACTS OF NOTE

VOODOO LOUNGE STAFF (708 Bourbon): Door staff (male, Hispanic, would not give name) stated he saw 'a group of white guys running from the alley direction' at approximately 1:30 AM. Could not describe further. Did not want to make formal statement.

CREOLE KITCHEN EMPLOYEE (706 Bourbon): Night cleaning employee stated she heard 'yelling and loud banging' from the alley direction at approximately 1:25–1:30 AM. She looked out the rear window but could not see clearly due to darkness. Called it 'just drunk people.'

STREET VENDOR (700 block, cart near alley entrance): Male, age approx. 50s, stated he packs up at 1:00 AM. Was gone before the incident. No relevant information.

IV. NON-PRODUCTIVE CONTACTS

Fourteen additional contacts were made with bar patrons, pedestrians, and business staff. None provided information relevant to the period between 1:15 AM and 2:40 AM in or near the alley. The French Quarter's ambient noise level and

pedestrian volume make witness identification difficult. Several contacts were intoxicated and unreliable.

V. ANONYMOUS 911 CALLER — NOT LOCATED

The female caller who made the 911 call at 2:40 AM was not identified during the canvass. Despite officers' presence on Bourbon Street throughout the morning, no individual came forward. Call records indicate the call was made from an iPhone registered to an unrelated subscriber — the phone may have been borrowed or the subscriber may not wish to be identified. Investigation into the caller's identity is ongoing.

Canvass Lead:	_____	Det. Renee Broussard #1887
Assisting Officer:	_____	Maria Thibodaux #2241
Report Date:	October 4, 2025	